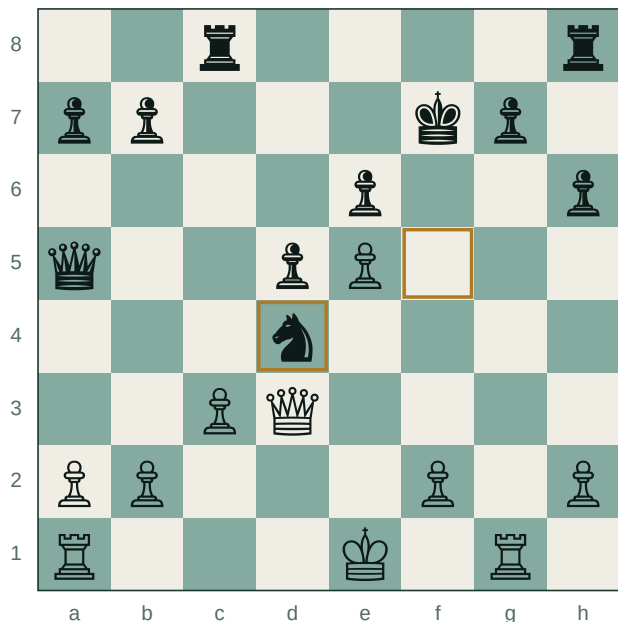


Interference tactics: White, move 21

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 20...Nxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Qg6+ Ke7 22. Qxg7+ Kd8 23. Qxh8+

21.Qg6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **21...Ke7**.

22.Qxg7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From g7 it attacks king on e7 and rook on h8. Recorded reply: **22...Kd8**.

23.Qxh8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on f7. Geometrically undefended: queen on a5 and knight on d4. Check for tactical protection.